

TUI

Quick Start

1. Enter the root interface (if the application was installed in the root directory using root privileges).

```
sudo su
```

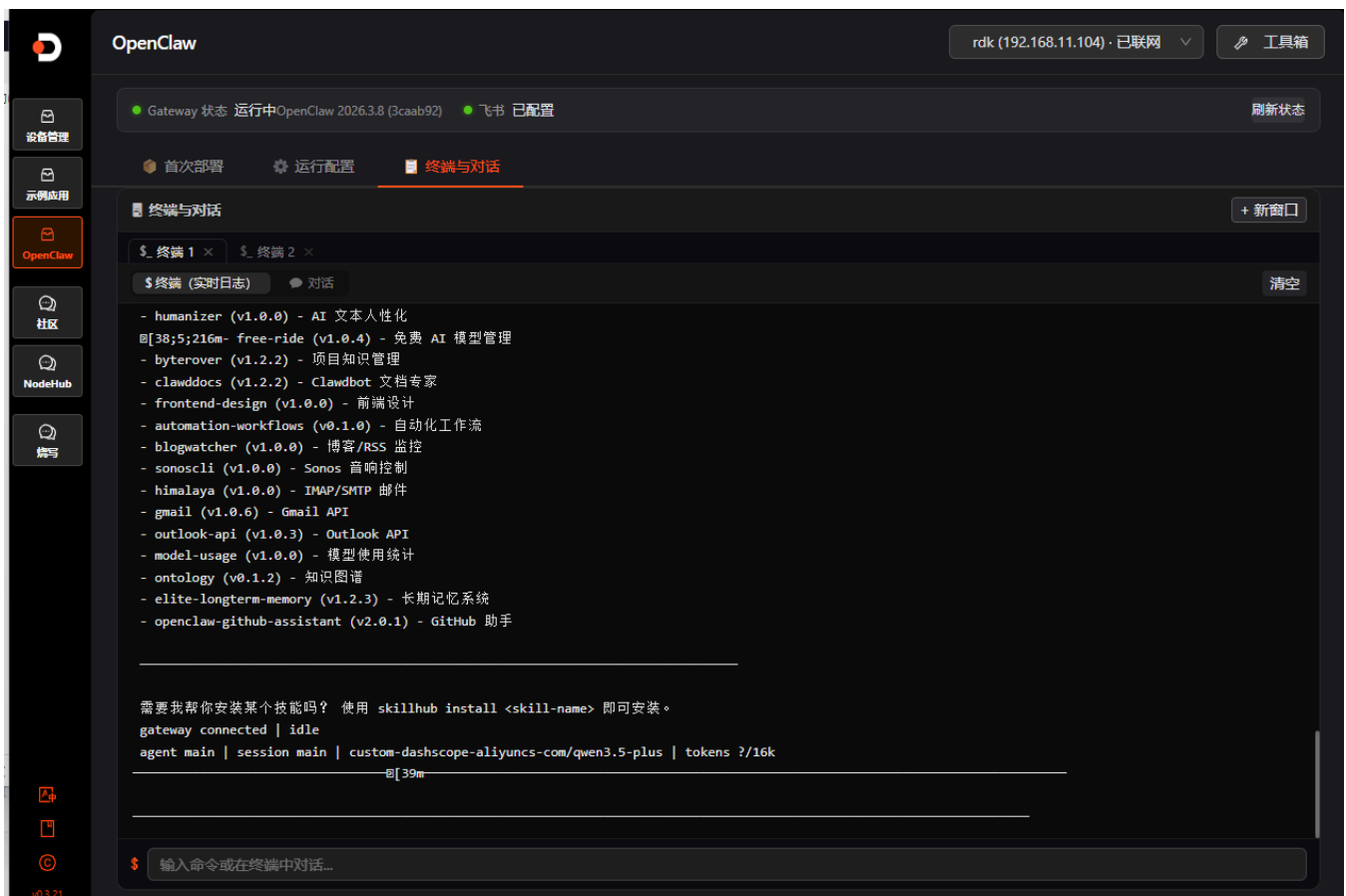
2. Start the Gateway. (Typically, the Gateway starts automatically, so running this command is not necessary.)

```
openclaw gateway
```

3. Open the TUI.

```
openclaw tui
```

4. Enter a message and press Enter.



Remote Gateway:

```
openclaw tui --url ws://<host>:<port> --token <gateway-token>
```

If your Gateway uses password authentication, use `--password`.

What You See

- Title bar: Connection URL, current agent, current session.
- Chat log: User messages, assistant replies, system notifications, tool cards.
- Status line: Connection/running status (connecting, running, streaming, idle, error).
- Footer: Connection status + agent + session + model + think/verbose/reasoning + token count + delivery status.
- Input: Text editor with autocomplete.

Mental Model: Agent + Session

- An agent is a unique identifier (e.g., `main`, `research`). The Gateway exposes a list.
- Sessions belong to the current agent.
- Session keys are stored as `agent:<agentId>:<sessionKey>`.
 - If you type `/session main`, TUI expands it to `agent:<currentAgent>:main`.
 - If you type `/session agent:other:main`, you explicitly switch to that agent's session.
- Session scope:
 - `per-sender` (default): Multiple sessions per agent.
 - `global`: TUI always uses the `global` session (selector may be empty).
- Current agent + session is always visible in the footer.

Send + Deliver

- Messages are sent to the Gateway; by default they are not delivered to the provider.
- To enable delivery:
 - `/deliver on`
 - Or the settings panel
 - Or launch with `openclaw tui --deliver`

Selectors + Overlays

- Model selector: Lists available models and sets session override.
- Agent selector: Select a different agent.
- Session selector: Shows only sessions for the current agent.
- Settings: Toggle delivery, tool output expansion, and thinking visibility.

Keyboard Shortcuts

- Enter: Send message
- Esc: Abort active run
- Ctrl+C: Clear input (press twice to exit)
- Ctrl+D: Exit

- Ctrl+L: Model selector
- Ctrl+G: Agent selector
- Ctrl+P: Session selector
- Ctrl+O: Toggle tool output expansion
- Ctrl+T: Toggle thinking visibility (reloads history)

Slash Commands

Core:

- `/help`
- `/status`
- `/agent <id>` (or `/agents`)
- `/session <key>` (or `/sessions`)
- `/model <provider/model>` (or `/models`)

Session control:

- `/think <off|minimal|low|medium|high>`
- `/verbose <on|full|off>`
- `/reasoning <on|off|stream>`
- `/usage <off|tokens|full>`
- `/elevated <on|off|ask|full>` (alias: `/elev`)
- `/activation <mention|always>`
- `/deliver <on|off>`

Session lifecycle:

- `/new` or `/reset` (reset session)
- `/abort` (abort active run)
- `/settings`
- `/exit`

Other Gateway slash commands (e.g., `/context`) are forwarded to the Gateway and appear as system output. See [Slash Commands](#).

Local Shell Commands

- Lines prefixed with `!` run local shell commands on the TUI host.
- TUI prompts once per session to allow local execution; denying disables `!` for that session.
- Commands run in a fresh non-interactive shell in the TUI working directory (no persistent `cd/env` variables).
- A standalone `!` sends it as a regular message; leading whitespace does not trigger local execution.

Tool Output

- Tool calls display as cards with parameters + results.
- Ctrl+O toggles between collapsed/expanded view.
- While a tool is running, partial updates stream to the same card.

History + Streaming

- On connect, TUI loads the latest history (default 200 messages).
- Streaming responses update in place until completion.
- TUI also listens to agent tool events for richer tool cards.

Connection Details

- TUI registers with the Gateway as `mode: "tui"`.
- Reconnecting shows a system message; gaps in events appear in the log.

Options

- `--url <url>`: Gateway WebSocket URL (defaults to config or `ws://127.0.0.1:<port>`)
- `--token <token>`: Gateway token (if required)
- `--password <password>`: Gateway password (if required)
- `--session <key>`: Session key (default: `main`, or `global` when scope is global)
- `--deliver`: Deliver assistant replies to the provider (default off)
- `--thinking <level>`: Override thinking level for sends
- `--timeout-ms <ms>`: Agent timeout in milliseconds (defaults to `agents.defaults.timeoutSeconds`)

Troubleshooting

No output after sending a message:

- Run `/status` in TUI to confirm Gateway is connected and idle/busy.
- Check Gateway logs: `openclaw logs --follow`.
- Confirm agents can run: `openclaw status` and `openclaw models status`.
- If you expect messages to appear in the chat channel, enable delivery (`/deliver on` or `--deliver`).
- `--history-limit <n>`: Number of history entries to load (default 200)

Troubleshooting

- `disconnected`: Ensure Gateway is running and your `--url/--token/--password` are correct.
- No agents in selector: Check `openclaw agents list` and your routing config.
- Empty session selector: You may be in global scope or don't have any sessions yet.

For more about TUI, see: [TUI - OpenClaw](#)